the instances when nationalist solidarity is fractured and betrayed'. In this way, we can see such figures 'as integral to the history of nationalism and martyrdom'.[11]

In fact, in the words of Durba Ghosh, 'Among participants of the underground groups, there were widespread concerns throughout the 1950s and well into the 1960s that the history of revolutionary terrorism would be forgotten.'[12] Indeed, so it has proved today because barely anyone is familiar with the names of these great revolutionaries outside India today, and even within India hardly anyone knows about their contribution to the cause of Independence. She refers to 'participants among the underground groups', but even in the mainstream now, no one knows. And few even care. Yet, it is a salutary reminder of how freedom is won. In fact, one reason for this is how postcolonial India has extended the shibboleth of Gandhian non-violence beyond Independence. As Ghosh explains, 'Between 1947 and 1952, the early years of independent India, as the government of India began a project of national consolidation, it resorted to classifying opposing political movements such as communism, trade union organization, battles for land redistribution as threats to national security.'[13]

One reason why the revolutionaries' political inclinations gave the colonial government much concern was because of the impact it had on liberal opinion at home. This is vividly demonstrated by the Meerut Conspiracy Case which arose in March 1929 when a railway strike was organized by several trade unionists. Three of them were Englishmen. The British Government convicted thirty-three of them in 1933 in proceedings which were widely regarded as being falsely contrived against them. This was one of the detrimental effects of colonization. And it was immediately seized upon by the Manchester Street theatre troupe, which ran a play by the name of *Meerut* in 1932. The play laid bare the savage prison sentences of the leaders of the Indian rail-strike.[14] The sentences were all the more harsh for fear of communist influence on them. As Durba Ghosh explains, 'Much of the concern in left and liberal circles about political prisoners in India focused on those arrested in the Meerut Conspiracy Case – who had